

Heuristic Evaluation Report

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Part I: Your Name

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Part II: Project Description

Skyscanner is an online platform that lets users search and compare flights. It provides destination search, filters, prices, and links to booking pages. Since EcoGo focuses on sustainable travel, looking at how a popular travel website works helps us understand common design choices and usability patterns. This connection makes Skyscanner a useful reference for improving the user experience of EcoGo.

Part III: Evaluation Execution

The heuristic evaluation was conducted individually on the Skyscanner website using a laptop and the Google Chrome browser. I followed the steps required by the assignment: first defining three user tasks, then navigating through the interface while applying Nielsen's ten heuristics. During the evaluation, I took notes on usability issues, interface behavior, and any difficulties encountered while completing the tasks.

All observations were based only on the information available directly on the website, which was sufficient to perform the evaluation. No external tools or documentation were used, and the platform was tested in normal conditions to reflect a typical user experience.

Part IV: List of Violations

Report the heuristics' violations you identified. Each of them must be numbered sequentially and formatted as follows:

- 1 H2 Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors
 - **Where:** Price graph view
 - **What:** When no flights are available on certain dates, the interface shows empty bars without explanations.

- **Why:** Users may not understand why a date is unavailable or whether it is a system error.
- **Severity:** 2

2 H5 Error prevention

- **Where:** Search bar
- **What:** Users can search with an empty return date even when selecting “Round Trip,” without a warning.
- **Why:** This can lead to unexpected results or incorrect trip configurations.
- **Severity:** 3

3 H8 Aesthetic and minimalist design

- **Where:** Results page with many ads and highlighted “best deals”
- **What:** Extra boxes and promotional elements visually overload the page.
- **Why:** This distracts users from comparing flights and reduces clarity of important information.
- **Severity:** 2

Part V: Summary and Recommendations

Violations Summary

Report the total number of identified violations:

Heuristic	# Violations
H1: Visibility of system status	1
H2: Match between system and the real world	1
H3: User control and freedom	0
H4: Consistency and standards	0
H5: Error prevention	1
H6: Recognition rather than recall	0
H7: Flexibility and efficiency of use	0
H8: Aesthetic and minimalist design	1
H9: Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors	0
H10: Help and documentation	0
HN: Non-heuristic issue	0

General Impressions and Recommendations

Overall, Skyscanner provides a clean and intuitive interface that makes it easy for users to search for and compare flights. The main features such as entering destinations, selecting dates, and browsing available options are straightforward and well-organized. Important information like prices, airlines, and flight times is presented clearly, which helps users make quick comparisons without feeling overwhelmed.

Despite its generally good usability, some elements of the interface may still create uncertainty during the search process. For example, when no flights are available for certain dates, the platform does not always provide clear explanations, which can make users unsure whether the issue is due to availability or a system error. In addition, certain areas of the results page feel visually crowded because of advertisements and highlighted promotions, which can distract from the main content.

To improve the overall experience, Skyscanner could clarify messages when no results are found and reduce unnecessary visual elements on the results page. Providing more informative feedback and streamlining the layout would help users stay focused on their search and make the interface smoother and more comfortable to use.